

Check out the neighborhood. Websites like <http://quicktake.morningstar.com>, <http://finance.yahoo.com> and www.quicken.com can readily tell you what percentage of a company's shares are owned by institutions. Anything over 60% suggests that a stock is scarcely undiscovered and probably "overowned." (When big institutions sell, they tend to move in lockstep, with disastrous results for the stock. Imagine all the Radio City Rockettes toppling off the front edge of the stage at once and you get the idea.) Those websites will also tell you who the largest owners of the stock are. If they are money-management firms that invest in a style similar to your own, that's a good sign.